acts of sabotage and that even the one which had been attempted had failed twice.' " – apparently referring to the attempt at the copper mine. He also stated that President Kennedy "is concerned about progress on the MONGOOSE program and feels that more priority should be given to trying to mount sabotage operations." He urged "massive activity." Roswell Gilpatric confirmed this sense: "The complaint that the Attorney General had … [was that] the steps taken by the CIA up to that point, [and] their plans were too petty, were too minor, they weren't massive enough, they weren't going to be effective enough."[62]

The Missile Crisis

Many volumes, and even more textbook entries, have been written about the Missile Crisis, or the Crisis de Octubre. Generally, in the United States, they have focused on the decision-making process of a few individuals over the period defined as the "crisis," during which American and Soviet officials played a dangerous game of brinksmanship – as epitomized by Roger Donaldson's film *Thirteen Days*. In this version, the Soviet Union backed down under U.S. strength and insistence.

In the United States, several Cold War assumptions surround the drama of the 13 days, and the early histories of the events. First, older accounts assumed that a relative balance of power existed between the United States and the USSR, and that the siting of the missiles in Cuba created a dangerous shift in this balance of power. Second, older accounts assumed that it was Kennedy's uncompromising strength that convinced the Soviets to back down and agree to remove the missiles. Third, most accounts assumed that Cuba had no need to defend itself against the United States – any missiles must be for the purpose of attack capability.

In the late 1980s the first set of revisionist histories began to be written. The National Security Archive at George Washington University used the Freedom of Information Act –and eventually, a lawsuit against the State Department – to obtain many previously classified documents